



Qualification Programme Examination Panelist's Report

Module 5 – Information Management (June 2022 Session)

(The main purpose of the following report is to summarise candidates' common weaknesses and make recommendations to help future candidates improve their performance in the examination.)

(I) Section A – Multiple Choice Questions

General Comments

This paper consisted of 20 multiple-choice (MC) questions. Candidates had to complete all the questions. The coverage of the questions was widely distributed among the topics of the syllabus as follows:

- (a) Analyse the role of e-Commerce;
- (b) Analyse the risks and security of information management;
- (c) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems;
- (d) Describe and apply corporate information systems;
- (e) Analyse systems development process; and
- (f) Use information technology applications.

The performance in the MC questions was good, as these are usually short and straightforward questions.

Specific Comments

Candidates showed weaknesses in the following areas:

- (a) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems – different types of data analytics;
- (b) Describe and apply corporate information systems – information needs of a marketing function / department and software applications supporting corporate information systems; and
- (c) Analyse systems development process – techniques for addressing resistance to a new information system.

(II) Section B – Written Questions

General Comments

Similar to the previous cohorts, most candidates performed well in some general and fundamental topics, such as segregation of duties, management information systems, and feasibility studies of system analysis. However, many candidates performed poorly



in some specific topics, such as the Porter's value chain model, information used by tactical-level management, pricing strategies of e-commerce businesses, online analytical processing, IT steering committee and input controls of data entry processing.

Specific Comments

Question 1(a) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to list four types of support activities of the Porter's value chain model with an example.

Performance was unsatisfactory. Many candidates listed some common names of business departments. A few candidates listed some primary activities of the model, which were not required.

Question 1(b) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to define the term "real-time data" and explain why accountants should be aware of such data as well as the benefits it will bring.

Performance was unsatisfactory. Some candidates could not use other word(s) to explain the term "real-time". Many candidates were not aware of the processing speed of real-time data.

Question 1(c) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to state three common types of cloud deployment models.

Performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates stated some service types of cloud computing which were not relevant to the question.

Question 2(a) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to describe any three planning activities before running an e-commerce business.

Performance was satisfactory. However, many candidates provided short answers without further describing how to perform these planning activities. Some candidates stated some general business operating activities instead of planning activities.

Question 2(b)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate psychological pricing with an e-commerce example.



Performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates wrongly mentioned offering a general sales discount rate on products.

Question 2(b)(ii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate bundle pricing with an e-commerce example.

Performance was satisfactory. However, some candidates wrongly mentioned offering bulk discount or providing a buy x get one free offer on the same product.

Question 2(b)(iii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate price-match guarantees with an e-commerce example.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates failed to mention the compensation or refund process under the price-match guarantees.

Question 2(c) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to justify why the type of the e-commerce business mentioned in the case should be consumer-to-consumer (C2C).

Performance was less than satisfactory. Candidates understood the concept of C2C e-commerce. However, many candidates failed to use the information provided from the short case to elaborate why C2C should be the most appropriate type of e-commerce.

Question 3(a)(i) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to analyse the given situations, apply an appropriate input control to each situation with justification.

Performance was poor. Many candidates applied an inappropriate input control or a user interface control to the situation.

Question 3(a)(ii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to analyse the given situations, apply an appropriate input control to each situation with justification.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Many candidates applied an inappropriate input control or a general manual operation control to the situation.

Question 3(a)(iii) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to analyse the given situations, apply an appropriate input control to each situation with justification.



Performance was better than part (i) and part (ii). Some candidates were able to mention a valid code test.

Question 3(b) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to state any two advantages of implementing segregation of duties among employees using information system.

Performance was good. However, some candidates mentioned the establishment of responsibility and/or improving efficiency which were not appropriate and relevant.

Question 3(c) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to contrast on the operation of symmetric and asymmetric key encryption.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Some candidates versed these two encryption methods or did not understand the operation of asymmetric key encryption.

Question 4(a)(i) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to interpret how information can reduce uncertainties.

Performance was poor. Many candidates failed to understand the meaning of “uncertainties”, and most of them used financial statements, sales reports or production reports as an example.

Question 4(a)(ii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to interpret how information can support problem-solving.

Performance was less than satisfactory. Some candidates failed to mention that information could address or identify business problems.

Question 4(a)(iii) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to interpret how information can become a potential revenue source.

Performance was good. Many candidates were able to interpret this matter appropriately.

Question 4(b) – 4 Marks

This question required candidates to justify the necessity of using external information by tactical-level management.



Performance was poor. Some candidates mentioned the necessity of using internal information instead of external information. A few candidates misunderstood the question, and they criticised the use of external information by tactical-level management.

Question 4(c) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to state and describe any two types of reports generated by a management information system (MIS).

Performance was good. However, some students mentioned the reports being generated by different departments.

Question 4(d) – 2 Marks

This question required candidates to define the term “online analytical processing”.

Performance was poor. Many candidates failed to understand this term, and they mentioned printing sales reports or financial statements with an online function.

Question 4(e) – 3 Marks

This question required candidates to demonstrate how to form a data cube for a regional cost analysis with some given data fields.

Performance was unsatisfactory. Many candidates failed to understand how to prepare and present a regional cost analysis, and they suggested presenting departments or branches in a regional cost analysis.

Question 5(a)(i) – 5 Marks

This question required candidates to describe two responsibilities and explain why it is necessary to let the company’s IT steering committee discuss and endorse a given IT project.

Performance was poor. Many candidates mentioned the key members of an IT steering committee without describing its responsibilities. Some candidates failed to understand the difference among an IT steering committee, an IT department, and an IT project team. They mentioned some responsibilities of an IT department or an IT project team.

Question 5(a)(ii) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to state and describe any three other types of feasibility factors should be analysed for a given IT project.

Performance was good. Many candidates were able to state two or even three types of feasibility factors. However, some candidates failed to describe them further.



Question 5(b) – 6 Marks

This question required candidates to determine two methods which could assist the project team in finding suitable and affordable POS systems under a specific situation – there are many providers of POS systems with different functions and system cost.

Performance was poor. Many candidates mentioned the “Request for information”, which is usually used for asking general (less detailed) information of some simple systems/ software with smaller or even similar cost (such as office application software, off-the-shelf accounting software or anti-virus software), or “Request for quote”, which is usually used for asking the price of a specific application software or equipment (such as a specific office application software or a specific model of computer or printer). A few of candidates misunderstood the question and they mentioned the pros and cons of a POS system.

(III) Conclusion and Recommendation

The overall performance of the candidates in this examination was less than satisfactory. In general, candidates performed poorly in relation to the syllabus areas of “Risks and security of information management”, “Describe and apply corporate information systems” and “Analyse systems development process”. Candidates should spend more time and effort to become familiar with the topics in these three areas.

Candidates are reminded again to read the questions carefully and address what is being asked. Be careful to identify the keywords from each of the questions. The answer is totally different between (1) “primary activities” and “support activities” and (2) “service models” and “deployment models”.

In this examination, some candidates failed to understand the requirement(s) of the verb “justify” (in Question 2(c), Question 3(a) and Question 4(b)), they just briefly described the matters without further elaboration or even criticise the matters involved. Candidates are advised to study the HKICPA Taxonomy and understand the requirements of different verbs when they are preparing for the examination.